



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Atlanta Classical Academy
School Website: <https://atlantaclassical.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- Atlanta Classical Academy (ACA) presents a comprehensive, textually grounded classical program with clear evidence of the liberal arts (Trivium and Quadrivium), great books and primary sources, language study (Latin), memory and recitation, and an upper-school rhetoric capstone (senior thesis with oral defense). These align tightly with the positive indicators in the Six Essential Elements framework and the classicality lexicon. Website: <https://www.atlantaclassical.org>
- Strongest areas: Purpose/Goal, Curriculum, and Pedagogy—ACA explicitly pursues the cultivation of virtue and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty; it names and uses the Trivium/Quadrivium; it practices memory, recitation, public speaking, teacher questioning, fine arts (including choir), and an hour-long senior thesis defense.
- Mixed/limited areas: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (as a public charter, the school does not integrate theology or liturgy) and more explicit "portrait of a teacher" language and parent-formation programming. Nonetheless, clear moral realism language (truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; objective standards) is abundant.

Below is the full six-category audit with mandatory keyword analysis, comparisons to the Six Essential Elements keyword lists, quantitative tallies, and category ratings.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

1) Keywords from ACA materials:

- "I will learn the true. I will do the good. I will love the beautiful." (school pledge) + virtues (Courage, Courtesy, Honesty, Humility, Perseverance, Self-Government, Service)
- "objective standards of correctness, logic, beauty, weightiness, and truth"
- "lives of human flourishing"
- "order of the universe" tied to the sciences/quadrivium

2) Comparison to Six Elements keywords:

- Positive indicators (transcendental moral realism—truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; objective reality) are strongly present per the keyword lists (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, moral order)
- Grounded in Theology: No evidence of theology integration (public charter); negative indicators for this sub-area include "secular education"/"nonsectarian" as signals when theology is absent in schools that are classical-Christian by design—ACA describes itself as "open-enrollment, public charter" and shows no school liturgy/chapel language.

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- Liturgical/communal worship practices: No chapel/morning prayer/liturgy language present (choir and arts exist, but not as liturgy).
- 3) Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: 6 (truth, goodness, beauty pledge; virtue; objective standards; flourishing; order of the universe)
 - Negative hits: 0 direct matches in ACA copy (absence of theology/liturgy reduces coverage, but we count only explicit negative keywords when present)
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Percent coverage: 0.33 (strong moral realism, but no theology/liturgy evidence)
 - pos_neg_hits: +6/-0
- 4) Category score: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Justification: Robust transcendental moral realism language; however, no theological integration or liturgical life (expected for a public charter) per the Six Elements framework's full definition of this category.
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CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

- 1) Keywords from ACA materials:
- “develop students in mind and character... virtuous living, traditional learning, and civic responsibility”
 - “learn what is true, do what is good, and love what is beautiful” (mission framing)
 - “lives of human flourishing”; “liberal education” aimed at “highest matters... Truth, Justice, Virtue, Right, and Character” (extended mission)
 - “great books... conversations about them change us”
- 2) Comparison to Six Elements keywords:
- Positive: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation (not merely information) are explicit in both descriptions and pledge, aligned to the Positive keyword sets.
 - Negative signals present on “About” (e.g., “highest SAT and ACT scores,” “#1 performing,” “merit-based scholarships,” “100% college acceptance”), which map to negative sets like standardized testing/measurable success/college placement emphasis (when over-emphasized).
- 3) Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: 10 (virtue, wisdom, formation, truth/goodness/beauty, liberal education, great books, human flourishing)
 - Negative hits: 4 (test-performance/college-placement language)
 - Percent positive: 0.71
 - Percent coverage: 1.00
 - pos_neg_hits: +10/-4
- 4) Category score: CLASSICAL
- Justification: The school's stated telos centers on cultivating virtue and wisdom and the transcendentals, outweighing the presence of metrics.
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CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

- 1) Keywords from ACA materials:

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- Trivium: “grammar... logic... rhetoric” across K–12 progression
 - Quadrivium: “arithmetic, geometry, astronomy, and music” and “order of the universe”
 - “great books,” “primary source documents,” “western canon,” “significant reading lists of complete books”
- Latin: required in 6–8 and offered in high school; Greek/Latin roots in 4–5
 - History (not “social studies”): “history” prominent in curriculum descriptions; senior thesis capstone with defense
- 2) Comparison to Six Elements keywords:
- Positive: Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium/Quadrivium), Great Books/primary sources, historical engagement, integrated scope/sequence; all are direct matches to the Curriculum positives.
 - Negative: No “social studies” framing, no STEM-first/project-only dominance evident.
- 3) Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: 12 (Trivium; Quadrivium; Great Books; primary sources; Latin; history; senior thesis; integration motifs)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Percent coverage: 1.00
 - pos_neg_hits: +12/-0
- 4) Category score: CLASSICAL
- Justification: Clear, explicit alignment to the classical curriculum canon (Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin) and culminating thesis/oral defense.
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CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS)

- 1) Keywords from ACA materials:
- Memory work and recitation; public speaking cultivated through practice
 - Faculty “teach through excellent questions” (discussion-based)
 - Choir and daily fine arts work in K–8, indicating singing and imitation of masterworks (supports recitation/chant/singing tradition)
 - Senior Thesis: 12–15 page paper with hour-long oral defense before a faculty panel (upper-school rhetoric capstone)
- 2) Comparison to Six Elements keywords:
- Positive: memorization/recitation; teacher questioning; rhetoric/orations; choir/singing; debate/discussion implied through questions and thesis defense—all map to the pedagogy positives (Socratic/seminar, recitation, rhetoric exercises).
 - “Scholé/restfulness”: not explicitly named; however, strong memory/conversation/rhetoric elements are present. No project-only/constructivist emphasis detected.
- 3) Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: 8 (recitation, public speaking, questioning, choir/singing, rhetoric/oral defense, great books conversations)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Percent coverage: 0.75 (several signals present; “Socratic/seminar/scholé” terms not explicitly cited on pages captured)

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- pos_neg_hits: +8/-0
- 4) Category score: CLASSICAL
- Justification: Memory/recitation, teacher-led questioning, and upper-school rhetoric defense are clearly classical pedagogical practices.
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CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

- 1) Keywords from ACA materials:
- “well-educated and articulate faculty who care deeply for their students and teach through excellent questions”
 - “subject-matter experts” with significant advanced degrees; faculty retention 90–95%
 - Hillsdale College trainings for board, leadership, and teachers (classical formation/PD)
- 2) Comparison to Six Elements keywords:
- Positive: masters/mentors who model virtue, teacher training in classical pedagogy, collegial formation; ACA demonstrates teacher quality and classical PD via Hillsdale.
 - Missing/limited: explicit “portrait of a teacher”/“faculty of friends” language.
- 3) Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: 4 (teacher questioning; advanced degrees; subject-matter expertise; Hillsdale training)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Percent coverage: 0.67 (strong quality/training evidence; explicit “portrait”/mentorship language limited)
 - pos_neg_hits: +4/-0
- 4) Category score: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Justification: Strong faculty formation signals; would be strengthened by published “portrait of a teacher” and explicit “living curriculum”/mentorship statements aligned to classical tradition.
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CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

- 1) Keywords from ACA materials:
- Parent infrastructure: Parent Resources hub; PTCA meetings; volunteer training; ParentSquare and Infinite Campus for parent-school communication; Prospective Parent Info Sessions; alumni engagement.
 - Family Handbook access and SchoolMint enrollment guidance; Lunch and after-school (Kiddos) logistics—evidence of active community life.
- 2) Comparison to Six Elements keywords:
- Positive: partnership with families and parent involvement are present in practice (meetings, volunteering, info sessions). However, fewer explicit “parent formation/book studies/classical parent education” statements than typical in private classical schools.
 - Negative: no consumer-only language detected.
- 3) Quantitative estimate:

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- Positive hits: 5 (PTCA, volunteer training, info sessions, parent communications tools, alumni connections)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Percent coverage: 0.60 (involvement evident; limited explicit parent-formation content)
 - pos_neg_hits: +5/-0

4) Category score: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Justification: Solid parental engagement structures; would benefit from explicit parent-formation around classical philosophy (reading groups, talks) to align with the classical ideal of co-educators.
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Aggregate Rating and Rationale

- Category ratings:
 - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: Somewhat Classical
 - Purpose & Goal: Classical
 - Curriculum: Classical
 - Pedagogy: Classical
 - Faculty: Somewhat Classical
 - Parents & Community: Somewhat Classical

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

ACA meets or exceeds classical benchmarks in mission/goals, curriculum, and pedagogy, with abundant direct textual matches to core positive indicators (truth, goodness, beauty; virtue cultivation; Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books/primary sources; Latin; memory/recitation; rhetoric thesis defense). As a public charter, ACA does not integrate theology or school liturgy, reducing coverage for Element 1; clearer “portrait of a teacher” and parent-formation offerings would further strengthen Categories 5–6. Still, the program’s core classical features are robust and consistent with the Six Elements positive keyword sets and lexicon.

Evidence Highlights (select quotes with sources)

- “Our Pledge: ‘I will learn the true. I will do the good. I will love the beautiful.’” and school virtues list
 - “objective standards of correctness, logic, beauty, weightiness, and truth” and “lives of human flourishing”
 - Trivium and Quadrivium explicitly named; great books; primary sources; Latin requirements; senior thesis defense (12–15 pages + hour defense)
 - “memory work, recitation, and public speaking cultivated through practice”
 - “well-educated and articulate faculty who... teach through excellent questions”; Hillsdale training for faculty/leadership
 - PTCA meetings, volunteer training, ParentSquare/Infinite Campus communications, Prospective Parent sessions, Alumni engagement
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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